Reported speech

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Contar lo que otra persona dijo cambiando tiempos, pronombres y expresiones de tiempo
- Usar say y tell correctamente
- Transformar preguntas, órdenes y peticiones al estilo indirecto
- Aplicar la tabla completa de cambios de tiempos y modales
- Usar reporting verbs como suggest, promise o refuse
- Saber cuándo no hace falta el backshift

Para pensar

Tu amiga te dijo ayer: «I'm tired». Hoy se lo cuentas a otra persona. ¿Dices «She said she is tired» o «She said she was tired»?

Explicación

Directo e indirecto

En el **estilo directo** copiamos las palabras exactas entre comillas: She said, "*I love pizza*." En el **estilo indirecto** (reported speech) las contamos con nuestras palabras: She said (that) *she loved pizza*. Cambian los tiempos, los pronombres y las expresiones de tiempo y lugar.



El cambio de tiempos (backshift)

Si el verbo introductor está en pasado (*said, told*), el tiempo de la frase retrocede un paso. El past perfect se queda igual.

Direct	Reported
present	past
past / pres. perf.	past perfect
will	would
can / must	could / had to

La tabla completa del backshift

Directo	Indirecto
present simple: «I **like** it»	past simple: he said he **liked** it
present continuous: «I'**m working**»	past continuous: she said she **was working**
present perfect: «I'**ve finished**»	past perfect: he said he **had finished**

Directo	Indirecto
past simple: «I **saw** it»	past perfect: she said she **had seen** it
will: «I'**ll help**»	would: he said he **would help**
can: «I **can** swim»	could: she said she **could** swim
may: «I **may** come»	might: he said he **might** come
must: «I **must** go»	had to: she said she **had to** go

Would, could, should, might y *ought to* no cambian.

undefined

Cuándo no hace falta cambiar el tiempo

El backshift no es obligatorio en dos casos:

- Si el verbo introductor está en **presente**, **present perfect** o **futuro**: «She **says** she **is** tired», «He **has told** me he **loves** the film».
- Si lo que se dijo **sigue siendo verdad** ahora: «The teacher said that the Earth **goes** round the Sun» (o *went*); «Sara told me she **lives** in Valencia» (si todavía vive allí).

En los ejercicios de examen, sin embargo, se espera que apliques el backshift salvo que sea una verdad universal.

undefined

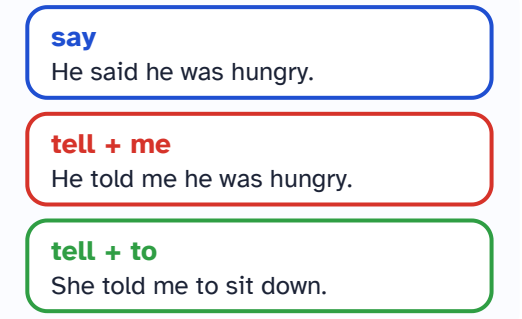
Pronombres, tiempo y lugar

Hay que adaptar todo al nuevo momento: *I* → he / she, *my* → his / her, **now** → then, **today** → that day, **tomorrow** → the next day, **yesterday** → the day before, **here** → there, **this** → that.



Say y tell

Say no necesita a quién: «He *said* (that) he was hungry». **Tell** siempre lleva a quién: «He *told me* (that) he was hungry». Para **órdenes** y peticiones: tell / ask + persona + (not) to + infinitivo: «She told me *to close* the door», «He asked me *not to* shout».



Reporting verbs: más allá de say y tell

Para escribir mejor, en lugar de repetir *said*, usa verbos que expresan la intención. Cada uno tiene su estructura:

Estructura	Verbos	Ejemplo
verbo + to + infinitivo	agree, offer, promise, refuse, threaten	He **promised to call** me.
verbo + persona + to + infinitivo	advise, ask, order, remind, warn, invite	She **warned me not to touch** it.
verbo + -ing	suggest, admit, deny, recommend	Tom **suggested going** to the cinema.
verbo + preposición + -ing	apologise for, accuse... of, insist on	He **apologised for being** late.

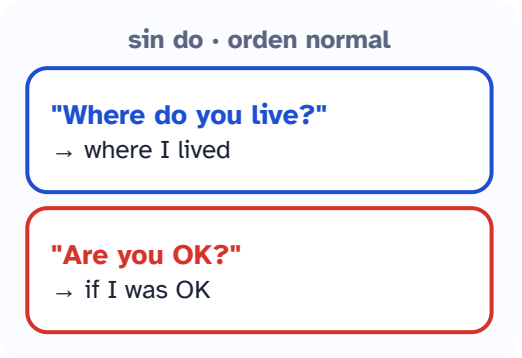
Estructura	Verbos	Ejemplo
verbo + that	explain, complain, admit, announce	She **explained that** the bus was late.

Error típico: ~~*She suggested me to go~~ → She **suggested going** / She suggested **that I (should) go**.

undefined

Preguntas en estilo indirecto

La pregunta se convierte en una frase normal: orden sujeto + verbo, sin *do* ni signo de interrogación. Con **wh-**: "Where do you live?" → She asked me *where I lived*. Con sí / no se usa **if** o **whether**: "Are you OK?" → He asked *if I was OK*.



Órdenes, peticiones y preguntas: resumen

- **Órdenes**: tell + persona + (not) to + infinitivo. «Sit down!» → He told me **to sit** down. «Don't run!» → She told us **not to run**.
- **Peticiones**: ask + persona + to. «Can you help me, please?» → She asked me **to help** her.
- **Preguntas sí/no**: ask + if / whether + sujeto + verbo. «Are you hungry?» → He asked me **if I was** hungry.
- **Preguntas wh-**: ask + wh- + sujeto + verbo. «What time is it?» → She asked **what time it was**.

En todas, desaparecen el signo de interrogación, las comillas y el auxiliar *do / does / did*.

undefined

Preguntas indirectas de cortesía

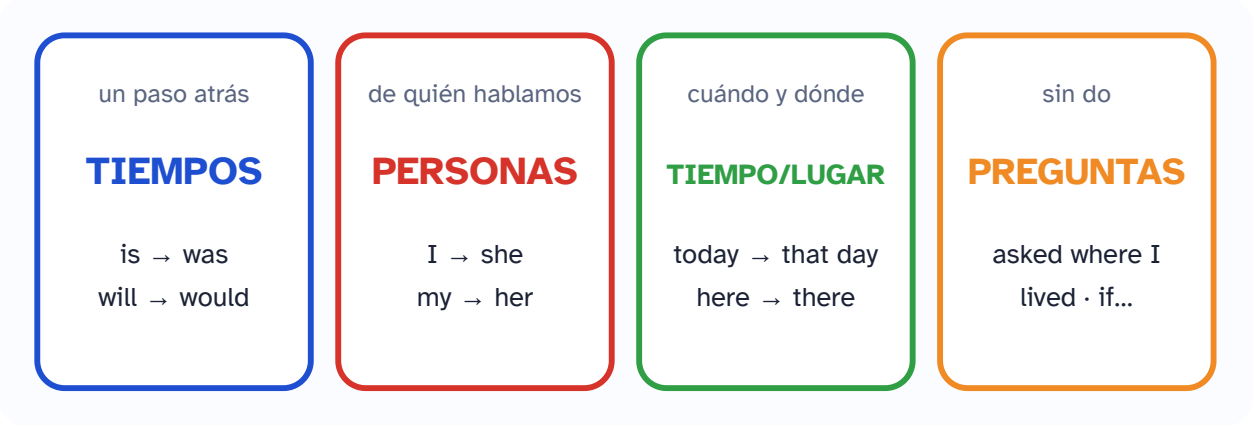
El orden de las preguntas indirectas se usa también para preguntar con más educación, sin estilo indirecto. Se empieza con una fórmula y después va sujeto + verbo:

- «Where is the station?» → «**Could you tell me where the station is?**»
- «What time does the museum open?» → «**Do you know what time the museum opens?**»
- «Is there a bank near here?» → «**I was wondering if there is** a bank near here.»

Son muy útiles en viajes, tiendas y emails formales, porque una pregunta directa puede sonar brusca a un hablante nativo, sobre todo si se la haces a un desconocido. Fíjate en que, igual que en el estilo indirecto, no hay do / does y el verbo va detrás del sujeto.

undefined

Qué cambia al contar lo que alguien dijo



Ejercicios

1. **Pasa a indirecto: «I can't come to your party,» Mark said.**

2. **Pasa a indirecto: «We have finished the project,» they said.**

3. **Pasa a indirecto: «I bought this jacket yesterday,» she said.**

4. **Pasa a indirecto: «Do you like jazz?» he asked me.**

5. **Pasa a indirecto: «Why are you crying?» Mum asked.**

6. **Pasa a indirecto: «Please, close the door,» the teacher said to us.**

7. **Usa promise: «I'll pay you back on Monday,» Leo said.**

8. **Usa suggest: «Let's watch a film,» said Ana.**

9. **Haz más cortés: «Where is the toilet?»**

10. **¿Es obligatorio el backshift en «He says he is ill»? Explica.**

Practica

1. **"I am happy," she said. → She said she ___ happy.**

   A) is

   B) was

   C) has been

2. **"I will call you," he said. → He said he ___ call me.**

   A) will

   B) would

   C) can

3. **Elige la correcta:**

   A) He said me the truth.

   B) He told me the truth.

   C) He told the truth me.

4. **"Where do you live?" → She asked me where ___.**

   A) do I live

   B) I lived

   C) did I live

5. **"Don't be late!" → Mum told me ___ late.**

   A) not to be

   B) don't be

   C) to not being

6. **«I must go,» she said. → She said she ___ go.**

   A) had to

   B) musted

   C) must to

7. **«Yesterday» en indirecto:**

   A) the day before

   B) tomorrow

   C) that day

8. **«Don't touch it!» → He warned me ___ it.**

   A) not to touch

B) to not touching

C) don't touch

9. **«Could you tell me where ___?»**

   A) the bank is

   B) is the bank

   C) does the bank is

10. **He ___ breaking the vase. (lo admitió)**

    A) admitted

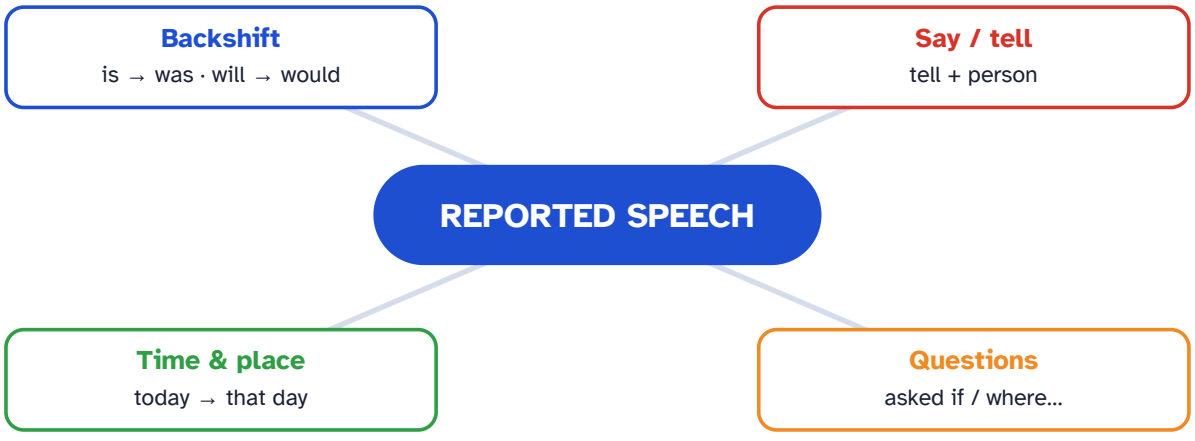
    B) promised

    C) told

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué es el backshift con dos ejemplos; La diferencia entre say y tell; Cómo cambian today, tomorrow y here; Cómo se transforma una pregunta.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Backshift

Al contar algo dicho en el pasado, el verbo retrocede un tiempo: is → was.

Will en estilo indirecto

Se convierte en would.

Say y tell

Say sin destinatario; tell siempre con destinatario: told me.

Preguntas indirectas

Orden sujeto + verbo, sin do; sí / no con if o whether.

Órdenes indirectas

tell / ask + persona + (not) to + infinitivo.

Must en indirecto

Pasa a had to: She said she had to go.

Reporting verbs

promise to, refuse to, suggest + -ing, apologise for + -ing, warn sb not to.

Pregunta indirecta cortés

Could you tell me where the station is? (sin do, sujeto + verbo).

Soluciones

1. **B)** Backshift: am → was.
2. **B)** Will → would.
3. **B)** Tell lleva el destinatario directamente: told me.
4. **B)** Orden afirmativo y sin do: where I lived.
5. **A)** Órdenes negativas: tell + persona + not to + infinitivo.
6. **A)** Must → had to.
7. **A)** También the previous day.
8. **A)** Warn + persona + not to.
9. **A)** Sujeto + verbo.
10. **A)** Admit + -ing.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. Mark said (that) he couldn't come to my party.
2. They said (that) they had finished the project.
3. She said (that) she had bought that jacket the day before.
4. He asked me if (whether) I liked jazz.
5. Mum asked (me) why I was crying.
6. The teacher asked us to close the door.
7. Leo promised to pay me back on Monday.
8. Ana suggested watching a film.
9. Could you tell me where the toilet is?
10. No, porque el verbo introductor está en presente (says).